

does not say his ancestors were "Great Kings" like himself, or the ancestors of Cyrus in the latter's inscription above referred to (quoted from Spiegel, *op. cit.* 84). A more local sovereignty will satisfy his words.

Suppose, then, that Darius's branch of the family were chieftains in Parthia, where Hystaspes is found after his son had won the supreme throne. We remember, of course, that Herodotus tells us that he was ὑπαρχος in Persia. If we had to choose between Herodotus and the Behistan record, the Greek historian must naturally yield. But there is no real difficulty, for when Darius was once on the throne his satraps could be moved very easily, and he would naturally wish to have his father nearer to his own court. But when it was a matter of quelling a serious rebellion, probably among the subject population, there would be obvious advantages in sending Hystaspes to a country over which he and his ancestors had ruled. On this conjecture, then, Parthia becomes an earlier settlement of the conquering Aryan invaders, from which a prince of the Achæmenian house, Cyrus's ancestor, went on to conquer Elam.

Now Parthia is exactly the district in which we should expect to find the earliest traces of Zoroastrianism proper. Lying east of "Zoroastrian Ragha," on the way towards Bactria, it suits equally well both the possible theories of Zarathushtra's sphere of teaching. He or his successors must have preached to the Parthians as soon as the Religion began to extend beyond its original home, whichever of the two centres may claim it. And this brings us to the remarkable coincidence noted above, in the recurrence